



Living in water

Ponds, rivers, and oceans are full of plants. These often grow quickly because they have access to a lot of water and sunlight. Some aquatic plants float on the surface, their flat leaves soaking up the sun's rays, while others are fully submerged. Many send up leaves and flowers from an anchored underwater root.

Flowering rush



Flower spike and leaves reach up to 5 ft (1.5 m) tall.

Waxy lily pads rest on the water's surface.

Water lily

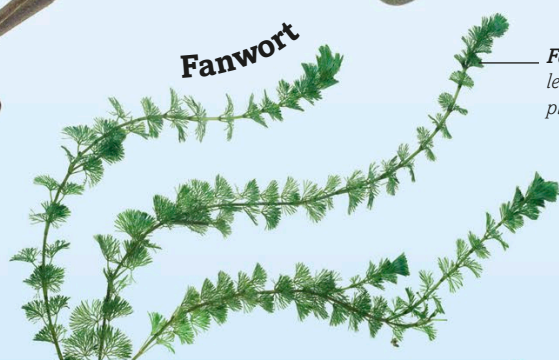


Air-filled leaf stalks help the plant float.

Water hyacinth



Fanwort



Fan-shaped leaves give this plant its name.

Hornwort



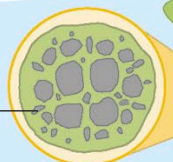
Stems, not roots, anchor this plant under water.



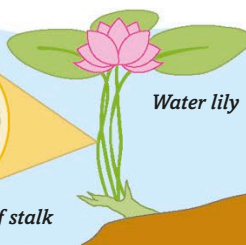
LIVING UNDER WATER

All plants need oxygen to survive. Some aquatic plants take in oxygen from the water, while others, such as the water lily, have tiny tubes in their stalks to carry air from above the water's surface to their roots.

Air spaces allow oxygen to pass from the leaves down to the roots.



Cross section of leaf stalk



Water lily